

Defender Sheet

Bridge Habit Map

AUCTION

Habits

- ☐ Check vulnerability - use to determine aggression level in competitive auction
- ☐ Always bid to show new info - stop when no new info to show
- ☐ Use every bid to get positive and negative info — partner + opps → HCP + shape
- ☐ Start from minimum length & min HCP promised — refine as bids land
- ☐ Use opps' conventional bids to show their HCP / shape
- ☐ By end of auction — summarise what you know about opps + partner - HCP and shape
- ☐ Pick a tentative opening lead during the auction

Strategy

- ☐ If it's our hand → bid our contract, or Dbl
- ☐ Watch for lead-directing double opportunities on artificial bids
- ☐ We have a fit AND opps have a fit + you have length or shortage in theirs → need fewer points for game (~20) in our suit
- ☐ After you T/O and opps make a game try — don't push the bidding
- ☐ When opps bid strangely, be careful

Bids to remember

- ☐ You can reopen with a Dbl
- ☐ Bid of a minor after 4th-hand protection shows a weak 2 in that minor
- ☐ After our T/O Dbl: NT from responder tends to show a max hand
- ☐ After our T/O Dbl: a new suit or NT is strong
- ☐ After our Neg Dbl: a new suit is a weak 6-card suit
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → partner's Dbl is for penalties
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → Pass is a forcing pass (partner must Dbl or bid the suit again)
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → bidding the suit again shows the strongest hand

DEFENSE PLAN

Discipline

- ☐ Don't rush, don't get rushed — especially trick 1

- ☐ No side-suit tricks for you? Look to trump (overruff, uppercut, promotion)
- ☐ Which 2–3 declarer hand-patterns let you beat the contract?
- ☐ What suit does declarer fear?

Active or passive (binary)

- ☐ Long-suit declarer with a source of tricks → ACTIVE
- ☐ Balanced declarer, no obvious source → PASSIVE (don't break suits)
- ☐ Don't grab aces prematurely — aces capture kings

Opening lead (if on lead)

- ☐ Determine if lead should be passive or aggressive
- ☐ Avoid suits opponents bid; favour unbid suits
- ☐ vs NT: 4th best from longest, or top of sequence
- ☐ vs suit: K from AK, top of doubleton; don't underlead an ace
- ☐ Trump lead if auction suggests a cross-ruff; not vs misfit
- ☐ Lead partner's bid suit unless you have a clear reason not to

Watch & remember

- ☐ Commit the first few cards from partner + declarer to memory
- ☐ Decide now which spot cards in which suits will matter

Defensive evaluation

- ☐ REAP — Zia update
- ☐ In competitive auctions, weigh partner's bids — especially the no-bids
- ☐ At trick 1, fix declarer's and partner's points and shape

Defensive play

- ☐ Changing suit: high discourages, low encourages the same-suit return
- ☐ Partner's discouraging opening lead → think about where his values are

Leads

- ☐ Lead a trump if opps are playing in their second suit (cut dummy's ruffs)